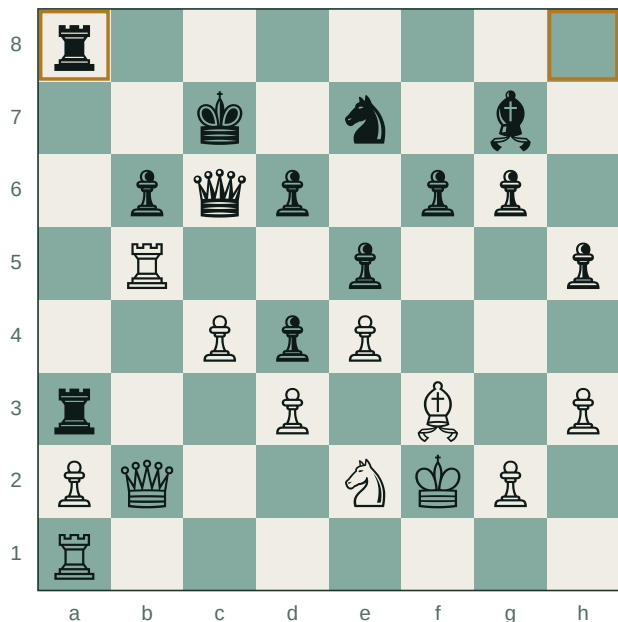


Calculated sacrifices: White, move 27

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 26...Rha8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Nxd4 exd4 28. e5 d5 29. cxd5

27.Nxd4 The knight captures the pawn on d4. Recorded reply: **27...exd4**.

28.e5 The pawn moves from e4 to e5. The changed line means the bishop on f3 attacks the queen on c6. Recorded reply: **28...d5**.

29.cxd5 The pawn captures the pawn on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -1 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on c7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on g7 and knight on e7. Check for tactical protection.